

1. The Fill Light

True to its name, a fill light fills the scene with ambient light, and doesn't cast any shadows. In the daytime, the sun is your fill light—sunlight bounces around your house lighting up everything, so you don't have to bother about lighting every nook and cranny. In the evening or at night, you can use a fluorescent lamp as the fill light.

2. The Key Light

This is the light that will lay emphasis to the details on the main subjects of the scene. The key light is the brightest light in the scene, and it's what you'll be using to play with shadows and highlights, and you should invest a lot of time in setting this up.

3. The Background Light

This light is placed behind the subject to soften any unwanted shadows.

4. The Rim Light or Kicker

This one is optional. The rim light is also placed behind the subject, and it adds definition to the subjects' edges. In the case of humans, it shines through hair (or on bald heads) for a halo-like effect.

The Backlight Fight

If you're shooting in daylight, you're often going to encounter situations when the sun is shining right into your camera, and anyone you film from this angle becomes a silhouette. You don't need to invest in expensive lighting equipment to fight this—you can get yourself some reasonably-priced reflectors from anyone who sells photography equipment and use those to bounce the sunlight onto your subject.

In The Dark

While many cameras come with a "Night Mode," you're best off not using that. The digital "enhancements" only lead to a lot of colour noise and your movie will end up looking grainy. However,